

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



Technology Support & Services challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of help desk operations and IT support through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply problem-solving, technical, and customer service skills to address real-world technology support issues in a business setting.

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

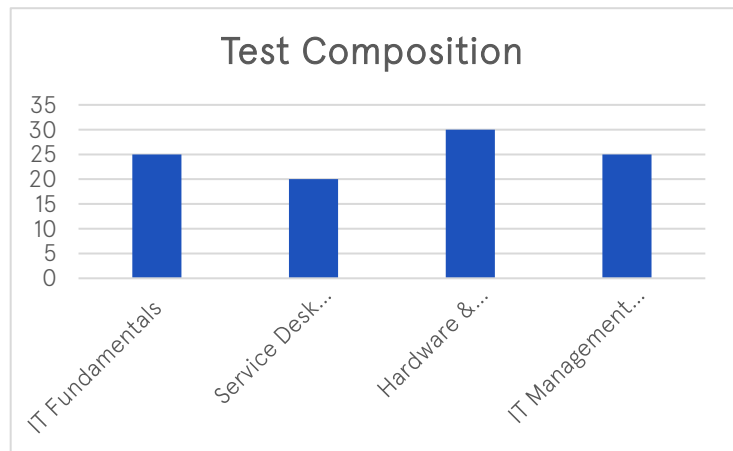
Educational Alignments

Career Cluster Framework Connection	Digital Technology
NACE Competency Alignment	Career & Self-Development, Communication, Critical Thinking, Leadership, Professionalism, Technology

Knowledge Areas

- IT Fundamentals
- Service Desk Operations
- Hardware and Software Troubleshooting
- IT Management and Administration

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	- Sharpened pencil - Fully powered device for online testing - Conference-provided nametag Photo identification - Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	- One piece of scratch paper per competitor - Internet access - Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	- Conference-provided nametag Photo identification - Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	- Two notecards per competitor - Pencil - Secret role play problem/scenario

Important FBLA Documents

- Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events [Policy & Procedures Manual](#), [Honor Code](#), [Code of Conduct](#), and [Dress Code](#).

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- Membership Deadline:** FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- Repeat Competitors:** Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Help Desk at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- Conference Registration:** Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- Official Hotel Requirement:** To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- State Entry Limits:** Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- Event Participation Limits:** Each member may participate in:
 - One individual or team event, and
 - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- Competitor Responsibility:** Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- Participation Requirement:** To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



- **Identification at Check-in:** Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals:** Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.
- **Event Schedule Notes:**
 - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
 - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
 - Schedule changes are not permitted.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review by the Competitive Events Committee prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a technology support-related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges

- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round. Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie in the role play round.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in [CONNECT](#). These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

IT Fundamentals (25 test items)

1. Describe the responsibilities of each layer of the OSI model
2. Discuss features of Windows for personal and enterprise environments
3. Discuss features of MacOS for mobile and PC systems
4. Apply command-line networking and troubleshooting tools for Windows and Linux (e.g., ipconfig, fsck, ping, tracertr)
5. Describe computer components (e.g., CPU, motherboard, GPU)
6. Interpret software requirements (e.g., 32-bit vs. 64-bit, memory, storage)
7. Describe best practices for digital security and privacy (e.g., VPN, password managers, firewalls)
8. Describe common security vulnerabilities and threats (e.g., out-of-date systems, SQL injection, DDoS)
9. Explain how information is exchanged between a computer and a network (e.g., packets, requests, servers)
10. Describe the functions of DNS and DHCP
11. Describe the functions of IP addresses in networked environments
12. Describe the key hardware components of a network (e.g., clients and servers, switches, routers, modems)

Service Desk Operations (20 test items)

1. Explain the importance of service and help desk teams in an organization
2. Discuss when tickets should be escalated
3. Discuss the role of IT Service Management (ITSM) in business
4. Discuss the functions of service desk software (e.g., JIRA, Zoho)
5. Describe service desk support tiers and their responsibilities
6. Discuss methodology for solving tech problems (e.g., identifying problem, testing theories, developing plans of action)
7. Describe the role of ticketing systems in IT support
8. Describe best practices for identifying and removing malware from systems

Hardware and Software Troubleshooting (30 test items)

1. Apply the best practice methodology to investigate tech problems
2. Distinguish between hardware and software problems
3. Describe solutions to common printer issues (e.g., connectivity, refillables)
4. Discuss common issues with mobile devices (e.g., battery life, overheating, connectivity)
5. Describe symptoms of problems with RAM, CPU, and storage
6. Describe tools used to fix and troubleshoot devices (e.g., multimeter, freeze spray, compressed air)
7. Distinguish between devices that need fixing, upgrading, or replacing
8. Troubleshoot common Windows OS problems (e.g., BSOD, crashing, slow performance)
9. Describe best practices for removing malware from a system
10. Describe indicators of malware on a device
11. Describe common solutions to hardware problems (e.g., restarting, unplugging, resting)
12. Describe common cable and connector types (e.g., USB, lightning, HDMI)
13. Describe types and parts of a liquid crystal display
14. Describe the boot process and options for its configuration

2025–2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



IT Management and Administration (25 test items)

1. Describe the role of change management in business and IT management
2. Describe elements of change request documents (e.g., time of change, rollout/backout plan, anticipated impact)
3. Discuss the use of remote access methods for IT administration (e.g., troubleshooting, testing, installing, updating)
4. Describe remote and virtual access software and protocols (e.g., SSH, RMM, RDP, VPN)
5. Describe file transfer services and protocols (e.g. FTP, Google Drive, OneDrive)
6. Discuss printer configuration settings (e.g., tray settings, duplex, orientation)
7. Describe types of printers (e.g., thermal, 3D, inkjet, laser)
8. Describe the use of load balancers in cloud environments and physical servers
9. Discuss key features of Active Directory
10. Describe the characteristics of different cloud services (e.g., SaaS, PaaS, IaaS)
11. Discuss spam mitigation and management techniques (e.g., DKIM, SPF, DMARC)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 1 Objectives*.

[https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-\(3-0\)](https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-(3-0))

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 2 Objectives*.

[https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1102-exam-objectives-\(3-0\)](https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1102-exam-objectives-(3-0))

Coursera. *Technical support fundamentals*. <https://www.coursera.org/learn/technical-support-fundamentals>

Google. *Google IT Support Professional Certificate*. <https://www.coursera.org/professional-certificates/google-it-support#outcomes>

IBM. *What is ITSM (IT service management)?* <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/it-service-management>

Unity Communications. *What is IT support? Our guide to key tools and service desks*. <https://unity-connect.com/our-resources/blog/what-is-it-support/>

2025-2026 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services



Technology Support & Services Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined	Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)	Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)	Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Communicates position on role play scenario	No position communicated	Communicates position not related to problem	Communicates position on problem	Communicates in a professional manner position on problem in scenario	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	No solution identified	Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed	Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed	Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Displays empathy/diplomacy when responding to role play scenario	No empathy or diplomacy displayed	Empathy or diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario	Empathy and diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario	Display of empathy and diplomacy skills add to resolution of role play scenario	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Shows knowledge of terminology and components related to the role play	No understanding of the role play demonstrated	Terminology is presented but not expanded on	Clear understanding of terminology and implementation into presentation	Terminology is communicated clear enough for client (judge) to proceed on their own	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates conflict resolution and closure to the role play	No closure was provided	Situation was closed OR conflict was resolved	Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure	Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure, and client (judge) is satisfied	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	Competitor did not appear prepared	Competitor was prepared, but flow was not logical	Presentation flowed in logical sequence	Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills	Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)	Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)	Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	Unable to answer questions	Does not completely answer questions	Completely answers questions	Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (100 points)					
Name(s):					
School:					Section:
Judge Signature:					Date:
Comments:					